

Transcript 3

So, as you know, based on the questionnaire that you filled in for me, we will just talk a bit about homesickness and voice recordings. And I would like to hear something that you think yourself about some stuff, some thoughts you have on certain topics. And there's no right or wrong. So you can just answer in any way you want. It's valuable for me, whatever you say. So, how are you feeling today?

I'm feeling okay. Yeah.

Any particular reason for you to not feel better or worse? If you are willing to share.

Yeah. Yeah, well, I didn't have the best sleep today. So that might make me a bit sleepy. But other than that, no. Okay. I don't have anything else.

All right, thanks. Let's see. And just to confirm, where did you grow up?

So, in which country? Yes, I grew up in Bulgaria.

Okay.

And where do you currently live?

I live in the Netherlands.

Yes. Okay.

And what place do you consider to be home for you?

I don't think it is a specific country. I think it's more, yeah, where I have close people next to me. Yes.

Yeah. So, it's not so much the physical location for you, but just the context around it. Just the people.

Yes. Yes. With the years, yeah, that changed, of course. First, it was home where I grew up. And then it changed. Yeah.

Okay. Yeah, I understand. And do you remember a time in your life when you were the most homesick?

Yeah. Maybe when I moved to the Netherlands at first. The first three years, they were very challenging to adapt. Yeah.

Yeah. I understand. And so, was that you missed location? I think you mentioned you missed the people the most. Was that the same here?

Yeah. I guess I missed understanding the people and how things work. And feeling like I belong and I'm not an outsider. So, yeah, just knowing what is going on around me. Yeah.

And would you say you're less of an outsider now? Or at least you feel like less of an outsider?

Yes. I do feel less of an outsider.

Okay.

Now.

Yes. Okay. That's good. So, I'm going to go into some questions about how personal or generic some voice recordings would feel to you. And this personalness, it doesn't necessarily mean that the audio needs to originate from someone personally close to you. But it needs to invoke a personal connection. So, it could be linguistic, historical, or cultural. It just needs to resonate a bit with you and feel close to you. And a generic voice recording, on the other hand, would not have that personal connection. So, if you would think about any voice recording that exists or might exist, which types of voice recordings do you think would feel more personal to you? And what is the context and their characteristics?

This is a good question that I don't really... Well, okay. A voice recording is also music, right?

Yes.

So, music that is coming from my country in the same language really makes me feel connected to it. And makes me appreciate... And, yeah, it makes me appreciate the culture and connect and feel less homesick. So, yeah. A lot of the times I was listening to music from there and thus, that's a version of course. So, I think that kind of answers your question, I hope.

Yes. Well, any answer is okay. And I think this is good, yeah. And do you think, or do you know what would make it more generic for you? Like a voice recording that wouldn't have a personal connection for you?

Well, I don't know. No, actually, anything connected with the country in any language, it would connect me to the country. Even if it's general, even if I don't know the

person, but they're the same nationality, I would kind of feel that I understand them. So, I don't think that there is a general recording that pushes me away from it.

Yes.. And so, you would say that one of the main things that at least would make it more personal to you is that it has that national connection to Bulgaria.

Yeah.

Okay. Now, I'm going to grab a link from another questionnaire I have. And I just want you to fill in the questionnaire. I'm going to explain a bit more to you. Yeah. So, I'm just going to share the link of the questionnaire in the chat right now. And I want you to just open this, keep it open during the whole interview. And I'm going to let you hear five voice recordings. And then, at first, you can let me know how personal or generic they feel to you. So, you will see like a statement in the first item that says someone talking about this and that. That's going to resonate with the first recording I'm going to show you, etc. And for now, you're just going to fit in the first five. So, I will let you hear something. You can tell me if you want to hear it again or if it's fine, you can go on to the next one.

Okay.

Okay. Are you ready for that?

Yes.

Also, please let me hear if you can actually hear it well.

Mm-hmm.

Okay.

[Voice recording audio: recording 1]

And now, I respond to the first question, right?

Yes. So, now, you fill in based on that scale and then we go to the next one when you're ready. Yeah.

Okay. I'm ready for the next... Oh, wait. So, do I respond to the five questions?

You respond to the first one. So, the first one is connected to the first recording and the second one to the second recording.

Okay. Yes. I'm ready for the second one.

[Voice recording audio: recording 2]

Okay. Yes.

[Voice recording audio: recording 5]

Yes. It is very funny because I know who that person is.

Okay. You actually know.

Yeah. Yeah. I'm ready for the next one.

[Voice recording audio: recording 12]

Okay.

Okay. And the last one for now.

[Voice recording audio: recording 19]

Okay. So you filled all the five in for now, and you can just keep the survey open for now. And based on what you responded in the voice recordings, do you think there's certain contexts and elements that make it more personal or more generic for you?

Yes, so I know all the three different voice recordings that were in my native language and I know which kind of these people are. So based on the function that they're having, I realized I feel some distance towards some of them. So basically if you're a politician, then of course I'm going to have a bit of a generic feeling.

Yes.

But yeah, okay, the most interesting part is the fluctuations in the way how they speak. This really makes it a bit more general, not general, more personal. Like you can kind of connect to the passion. Yeah.

Yeah. And also, of course, I don't know anything about your political views because obviously the man who was speaking, he has a certain viewpoint. Do you think if it resonates with you or it doesn't resonate with your own personal view, that would have more of the impact on how personal it would be for you?

I think it would have, like, it would become more personal, yes.

Okay, yeah. Thanks already for now. So I'm going to go on to a different variable, which is meaningfulness of voice recordings. And so with meaningfulness, I kind of mean whether a voice recording feels in any way important or relevant to you. So whether the voice recording actually resonates with you and to what extent it means something to you. And this can be emotionally, but it can also just feel important to you without emotions, just reminding you of something valuable or significant to you. And a voice recording could, for example, be very personal, but not that meaningful or vice versa. So it could be not personal, but still mean something to you. Okay. So I continue. Yes. First, we're going to have some more interview questions and then we can go to the to the questionnaire. So with the listening. So first of all, just an open question. If you think about voice recordings, again, in general, do you think what would make them more or less meaningful to you?

In general, voice recordings without any specific language?

It doesn't matter at all. So what would make them meaningful to you? Just the context that it would be in the characteristics that it has.

Yes. Yes. Um, I would say that it would be more meaningful if I know what the speaker is talking about. And then I can, even if I don't understand them, I can, to some degree, understand their feelings about the thing that they're talking based on how they're talking. Um, yeah. So again, the fluctuations in that voice. Yeah.

Yes, so can you describe if you could answer it, how this, um, connects to your understanding of the difference between voice recordings, you would consider personal and generic. So for example, do you think that a voice recording that is personal for you would also often be, uh, be meaningful?

Meaningful. Let's define meaningful in this case. Like, yeah. So meaningful in, in having some meaning for me. So having some result out of it or.

Yes. So yes. Meaningful if it resonates with you. Um, and just, if it means anything to you, makes you kind of feel through any way.

Okay. Um, so can you repeat the question?

So if, uh, you can describe how, um, let's see. So if a recording is very meaningful to you, how that connects to your understanding of voice recordings that you would consider personal versus generic.

Um, okay. Well, I guess if it's meaningful for me, then it would mean that it is personal and that I have some emotional connection to it. Um, let's say that a friend is saying happy birthday and they say, they wish me all these nice things and they tell me something about me in our relationships or relationship. Of course, this is

going to be very meaningful for me and it will be deeply appreciated and I'll come back to it. Yeah.

Yeah. So if you would think about specific characteristics of, uh, voice recordings that would be meaningful to you, what do you think would be very key characteristics to decide that?

Okay. Um, wow. It has to, it's not per se coming from a person that I know closely, but it's a person that I can connect with, even if I don't know them. And even if they don't know me, but they're talking about a relevant topic that I'm interested in and they're having similar experience as I am. Yeah. Or they just can't understand the situation that I'm in and they can talk about it. Um, I can see that they actually comprehend what I'm telling them.

Um, yeah, it would be more than, uh, also a bit approval that you would then get.

Yeah. Yeah. Validation. I can understand.

Okay. Yeah. And can you think of a situation or situations in which one and the same voice recording would feel more meaningful in one situation and less meaningful in another? And what I mean by different situations is for example, being alone or with people surrounded, um, in home or public or feeling homesick or not.

You have difficult questions.

It's okay. You can take your time. And also if you don't know an answer, that's, that's fine as well. I can also put that down.

No, um, I think I can try to answer your question. Um, okay. So can you repeat it?

Yes. Of course. So if you would take one specific voice recording, can you think of a situation or multiple situations in which that same voice recording would be more meaningful in one situation and less meaningful in another?

Uh-huh. Okay. I see. Um, well, yes. When I'm feeling homesick, down, then that personal message is going to have much more meaning than when I'm kind of with people or outside of my personal time. Yes. Yeah.

Okay. Okay. Let me see. Okay. So we can now go back to the, to the questionnaire again, and then you will have basically the same five statements, but then rating based on not meaningful at all to very meaningful. I'll just let you hear the same voice recordings you've just heard already, and then you can fill them in for meaningfulness now.

Yeah.

Okay. I'll let you hear the first one.

[Voice recording audio: recording 1]

Okay

[Voice recording audio: recording 2]

I am just getting an amber alert during the.. oh, it's 12 o'clock first Monday of the month

I can hear it, by the way.

Okay, great.

You can just play it. It is fine.

Yes. Okay, I'll just continue now. I'll just continue now.

[Voice recording audio: recording 5]

Okay

Okay.

[Voice recording audio: recording 12]

Yeah

[Voice recording audio: recording 19]

Okay. And so now, based on what you filled in, do you think specific elements or situations, specific elements of the situations in the recordings, affected the meaningfulness score you gave? So what made them more or less meaningful?

The energy that the speaker gives to the public.

Yes, so I think you also said it a little bit before, but even in the same language, the energy really matters?

Yeah

So would you say between those three recordings in the native language, you have one that stands out more in terms of energy?

Yes, it is the first one about the weather in my native language.

Okay, and is that like positively standing out?

Yes, it is positively standing out.

So, what about that specific recording makes it more positive then, within the energy?

I think it is generally speaking the fun, energetic energy that the speaker has. And the... it is, he's using the language in a very nice way that reminds me of specific people that I know in Bulgaria and that I like. And yeah, it reminds me of that part of society there. And I like that part.

Yes. Okay, thanks. So for the last of the three sections, I'll move on to actual supportiveness for coping with homesickness of the recording. So with the supportiveness for coping with homesickness, I mean, whether you feel like the voice recording actually would alleviate your feeling of homesickness and to what extent? Or potentially worsen your feeling of homesickness and to what extent? So if you once again think about voice recordings in general, which characteristics or aspects of it do you think impact that way of coping with homesickness? So what makes it better or worse?

Okay. Was that a question?

That was an open question. Yeah.

I thought that I'm going to listen to more things. I'm sorry.

No problem.

Yes. Can you repeat the question in this case?

Yes. So if you just think about voice recordings in general again, then what do you think in terms of the characteristics and the aspects of them? What makes them help more for you to alleviate your homesickness or maybe what makes them worse? So what worsens your homesickness?

So worsens the homesickness, meaning that I'm feeling more homesick and the opposite is feeling less homesick.

Yes. Okay. And you're asking about the voice characteristics or voice memory characteristics.

Yes. So it could be characteristics of the voice itself or just about what type of voice recording it is, where it's from, just anything in that sense.

What type of voice? Well, a voice that is connected with a typical, let's say, iconic person from Bulgaria that everybody knows. That would definitely reduce the homesickness, I think. Because if I recognize it and I know, and then I will feel like, oh, it is great that I know and I can connect with that. And what could worsen it? I think having very sad tones, talking about aging and family, then that would definitely make me more homesick. Yeah. So the energy is going to be down and depressive.

Yes. Okay. And for this same thing, can you think of a situation or situations in which the same voice recording would feel like it's more supportive for coping with homesickness in one situation and less supportive in another?

Okay so i will think out loud

yes that's okay

so listening to music that is in bulgarian would help with the feeling of homesick and then it would reduce the feeling and if i'm listening to home music like yeah music from there while i'm with other people and they don't appreciate that music they don't understand it and they can't connect with it so they're not from the same country then i would definitely feel down and that would increase my homesickness

yes so that's more like for example if you were in bulgaria and you were with a group of people there listening to the music they would resonate with it and that would make you feel more resonating with them maybe

yes

yes. um let me see so just um any characteristics that would make voice voice recordings kind of good for coping with homesickness for you is where the energy is is great um and would you say the language always has to be bulgarian or any language?

um i wouldn't say any language i would say more cultural uh just uh yeah culturally to have an overlap and then yeah i can understand them as well

yes so for example just in english but at least if it's about the music or about a cultural event some national holiday would still be able to resonate

yeah yes

so now we can go back to the questionnaire for the final time okay and then i'll let you hear the same five recordings again you can just let me know in which way you think it's either very supportive or not supportive at all

[Voice recording audio: recording 1]

[Voice recording audio: recording 2]

[Voice recording audio: recording 5]

[Voice recording audio: recording 12]

[Voice recording audio: recording 19]

Okay. And based on these five recordings now, what would you say are the characteristics of those situations that affected the supportiveness rating that you gave? So what made it more or less supportive for you?

Again, the energy and the meaningfulness of the message.

Yes. So you would say that at least the meaningfulness is very in line with if it's supportive for you as well?

Yes.

Okay. So, based on what we just talked about, your meaningfulness was the highest for the recording of the weather report, I think, based on the energy and the tone. Would you say it's also the highest supportiveness score for this time as well?

Yes.

Okay. And that's also because of the energy?

Yes. And to some degree, because that person, I have seen them on the screen so many times. So I already know who they are. And I have built some, yeah, some relationship just by looking at the TV with them. So it is, yeah.

Yes. So would you say the relationship, kind of with the third recording, so the weather report, is also a bit more personal than the other two?

Mm-hmm. Yes.

Okay.

I would say so, yeah.

And finally, I would like you to imagine you receiving a voice recording of someone very close to you. So a family member, maybe another loved one, a very good friend, and they are speaking to you directly about something personal. And how meaningful would that be to you and why?

It would be very meaningful. Because I have established relationships with them. And they know me, and they can help me in that situation to go through whatever I am personally going. And I can listen to their advice because I trust them.

Yes. Okay. I understand. And how supportive for coping with homesickness do you think such a recording could be?

Very much. Very much. Because, for example, I have collected a lot of postcards from friends with messages. And I like reading through them and just having visuals or voice recordings where they're saying something that is very important for me. And I replay it when I feel down.

Okay. Yeah. Let me see. And so those voice recordings can be from people that are in Bulgaria. And do you think that physical distance that's between you and them could also have an impact on the supportiveness for the homesickness?

Yes. Yes. I would say yes. It can have... Just because we are far away, it can make those messages more important.

Yes. Okay. So the meaningfulness would be a bit higher of the messages?

Mm-hmm. Yeah.

Okay. Thanks. And so is there anything that we haven't covered about voice recordings, homesickness, meaningfulness, or anything else that you feel is important to share in this context?

I'm thinking... I don't think so.

Okay. That's totally fine. Let me see. So, if you're willing to share this, if you also can think of something, if you would choose one kind of voice recording or one specific voice recording that comes to mind, that feels very effective for you in moments when you feel very homesick and you want to alleviate it, do you know what it would be?

Two answers. Kind of on the same level. Having voice recordings from family and friends very close to me and music from Bulgaria.

Yeah. All right. So, that was it. Is there anything you want to add?

Okay. So, I submitted the survey.

Yeah. Okay.

I think you should have it. And I don't have anything to add to the interview, but I would say that it is a very interesting research that we're doing.

Thank you.

Yeah. And I'm happy that I participated. So, the next step, I saw that you have this interview.

Yes. So, there was in fact a next step, which is kind of to analyze a prototype. But I've kind of shifted from doing that now, but first collecting some more interview results. And then based on that, I'm going to change a bit of the prototype and then re-invite people to maybe go over that. So, it would be a different time. I'm just going to ask everyone if they want to participate again. And then it would only take about maybe 10 minutes, but it would be a different time. So, I will send you an email about that. And then if you have a different day in which you can participate, you can do it. And if not, that's also okay.

Yeah. Okay. Do you need more people to do your survey or?

Yes, I actually do.

Yeah. Okay. Then I can share with my friends.

That would be great. Yeah.

And out of curiosity, are you making an LLM that is having the voice recording? Can speak and can have voice output?

No, no, I'm not doing anything with any data in machine learning or AI. I'm not doing anything with generative stuff at all. It's just an exploratory study. So, I'm basically looking at what people think, what they have in mind to get a broad overview about it. And then potentially in future research, it could go that way, but that's not what I'm doing.

Okay. Thank you.

Yeah. Thank you too.

Okay.

Have a nice day.

You too.

Bye.